

Do not be TROUBLED

Many Christians today are crying, lamenting, murmuring and cursing everyday about their situations because their lives are centered on how they are faring, what they have

in possession and how much they can acquire before they die. The concentration is so much on how they are feeling and how they are treated

We are reminded that it must be all about Jesus and not ourselves. The current situation you are must not rule over you. Bitter situations of sickness, poverty, hardships, rejection, isolation, barrenness etc. or beautiful situations of riches, good health, good career, profession, beautiful marriage, likeable body shape and so on. You must not allow any of these situations to rule over you

The rich must not concentrate on their wealth. The poor too must not concentrate on their poverty. The sick must not concentrate on their sickness and the handsome and the beautiful should not concentrate on their looking

Let us read a sermon from the gospel of **John 16:33** which reads **"I have told you these things, so that in me you may have peace. In this world you will have trouble. But take heart! I have overcome the world."**

Jesus in other words is saying "be happy, have courage for I have overcome all things for your sake. As you live in the world you shall face troubles (tribulation) but if you stay in me you shall find peace"

We get too much worried about unfavorable situations facing us (poverty, joblessness, sickness, barrenness because we have refused to live in the truth of this word

If any one believes in the word, he or she is also with HIM, for HIM is the word. He or she will live to enjoy the peace He is talking about. Ask yourself "do I believe in the word?" are you with Him?

The Lord (Jesus Christ) has conquered the world and given you victory. No matter what situation you are going through, if you are in Him and He is in you, you will enjoy peace. What are you passing through? Tell Jesus "Lord, I want that peace you promised the disciples"

No situation comes as a bad luck or by chance, the Lord has allowed it upon His lovely children. It is not strange and should not make you to doubt God's protection over you. I want you to know this, that a man can be poor, sick, without a job, dirty in the body, without career, without a family etc. but still be a friend, a child of God and a candidate of heaven

Whatever the unpleasant situation you are passing through, I have a message for you, that the grace of God is sufficient for you. Remember the Lord your God! See what Moses told the sons of Israel in **Deuteronomy 8:18** **"But remember the Lord your God, for it is he who gives the ability to make wealth, and so confirms his covenant, which he swore to your ancestors, as it is today"**

Your situation may have come to check the strength of faith you have since you the time encountered the true God. This also could be the reason why it has not gone away despite many prayers and countless visits to the doctor.

Satan loves to use your situation to make you start to doubt the integrity or truth of the scripture. When you start to doubt the scripture (the word) you are certainly doubting God. Satan knows that the moment a man begins to doubt God, God is not with him. He made Eva (Gen 3) doubt God and the next moment

both her and Adam were wondering outside the Garden of Eden, for God was no longer with them

We should not because of our situations cut off (withdraw) our dependence on God. Your situation should not stop you from counting God a priority

Many Christians today no longer look unto God when trouble come, or when the going become tough. They forget that they have been made children of God (according to **John 1:12**)

Satisfaction in life is not about having these things (Children, money, Cars, Estates or other worldly possessions) but rather it is about experiencing God. That is, seeing God impact your life. Until one has experienced God he/she lives in dissatisfaction.

The greatest thing Satan aims at in tempting good people is to overthrow their position as children of God. He succeeds when you:

1. You cut off your dependence on God and turn to people and things
2. Neglect your duty to God
3. Stop your communication with God

I said and will repeat that the devil aims to shake our faith in the word and bring us question the truth of the word.

We end the sermon by reading **John 14:27** **"Peace I leave with you; my peace I give you. I do not give to you as the world gives. Do not let your hearts be troubled and do not be afraid."**

If you have found peace because of having this and that (material things) kindly know that this peace is time bound. It will soon collapse leaving you in distress

God given peace is everlasting. Not a man or a group of men or armies of the world or even the Devil can take it away

You will be sick but you will be in peace. You will be poor but you will have peace. You will have no car but you will have peace. There will be hunger and famine but peace will bind you. God said to Abraham that he (Abraham) shall join his ancestors (in death) at advanced age and in peace (Genesis 15:15). Everything about God's peace is good

Are you saying in your heart you need this peace? Are you troubled by anything?

I want to pray with you in accordance with the word in John 16:33 and 14:27

Let us stand in a beautiful worship song and pray that God's peace will bind with us forever and ever

Amen!

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